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**FIRST SEMESTER 2026-27**  
**COURSE HANDOUT**

**Date: 01.08.2026**

**Course No** : BITS F385  
**Course Title** : Introduction to Gender Studies  
**Instructor-in-Charge** : Dr. Madhurima Das  
[Email: madhurima.das@pilani.bits-pilani.ac.in, Chamber No. 6168Q]

- 1. Course Description:** Introduction to Gender Studies and Feminist Movements; Theories of Gender; Sex, Gender and Sexuality; Social Construction of Gender; Intersectionality and Social Location; Marriage, Family and Gender Discrimination; Gender and Labour Politics; Productivity and Labour Issues; Unpaid Domestic Work and Gendered Labour; Globalization, Global Assembly Line, Care Work and Emotion Labour; Ideal Worker Norm and Second Shift; Gender Discrimination in the Workplace; Media Representations and Male Gaze; Theories of Masculinity; Gender Based Violence.
- 2. Scope and Objective of the Course:** To develop the knowledge necessary for addressing issues of gender equity and understanding gender roles. The course would help students get a greater insight into women's rights, their role in shaping political, social, economic and cultural institutions. Emphasis would be laid on understanding the dynamics of gender relations in educational institutions, work and home. The course would further aim at gender sensitization in the context of societal stratifications.
- 3. Course Learning Outcomes:**
  - Familiarity with the foundational concepts, scope and relevance of Gender Studies as a discipline.
  - Understanding of the historical trajectory of feminist movements and their theoretical contributions.
  - Understanding of the social construction of gender, sex and sexuality through key theoretical frameworks.
  - Understanding of intersectionality as a framework for analysing overlapping systems of identity and inequality.
  - Evaluating the dynamics of gender discrimination within institutions of marriage and family.
  - Understanding the gendered dimensions of labour politics and workplace discrimination.
  - Evaluating the politics of unpaid domestic work and its relationship to gendered labour.
  - Understanding the impact of globalization on gendered labour, care work and emotion labour.
  - Understanding the ideal worker norm and the second shift as frameworks for analysing gender discrimination in the workplace.
  - Evaluating media representations of gender and the concept of the male gaze.
  - Understanding theories of masculinity and their relationship to gender-based violence.



4. **Text Books and References:** <https://openbooks.library.umass.edu/introwgss/>  
Additional readings will be uploaded on Nalanda. Class slides/discussions and lectures are important.

5. **Course Format and Weekly Workflow:** Weekly schedule for 14 weeks with [3] lectures per week

| Week No. | Lecture No. | Learning objectives                                                      | Topics to be covered                                            | Ref. to text book chapters                              | Learning Outcomes |
|----------|-------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
|          | 1-4         | Scope and relevance of gender studies<br>Feminist Movement (history)     | Introduction to Gender Studies, Feminism and Feminist Movements | Will be mentioned in lecture<br>Class notes/discussions |                   |
|          | 5-8         | Sex, Gender and Sexuality.<br>Social construction of gender and theories | Theories of Gender                                              | Will be mentioned in lecture<br>Class notes/discussions |                   |
|          | 9-11        | Identity, Social Location and Intersectionality.                         | Intersectionality and social location                           | Will be mentioned in lecture<br>Class notes/discussions |                   |
|          | 12-15       | Marriage and Family and gender discrimination                            | Marriage and Family                                             | Will be mentioned in lecture<br>Class notes/discussions |                   |
|          | 16-18       | Gender and Work/Labour                                                   | Labour politics                                                 | Will be mentioned in lecture<br>Class notes/discussions |                   |
|          | 19-20       | Productivity in labour and gender discrimination                         | Labour issues                                                   | Will be mentioned in lecture<br>Class notes/discussions |                   |



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|  |       |                                         |                                                                   |                                                      |  |
|--|-------|-----------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|--|
|  | 21-24 | The household space and gendered labour | Unpaid domestic work and gender                                   | Will be mentioned in lecture Class notes/discussions |  |
|  | 25-28 | Globalization and gendered labour       | Globalization, global assembly line, care work and emotion labour | Will be mentioned in lecture Class notes/discussions |  |
|  | 29-32 | The workplace and second shift          | Ideal worker, second shift, gender discrimination                 | Will be mentioned in lecture Class notes/discussions |  |
|  | 33-36 | Gender and Media                        | Media representations, Male gaze                                  | Will be mentioned in lecture Class notes/discussions |  |
|  | 37-40 | Masculinity and gender-based violence   | Theories of masculinity, Gender based violence                    | Will be mentioned in lecture Class notes/discussions |  |

**6. Evaluation Scheme:**

| EC No. | Evaluation Component      | Duration   | Weightage | Date, Time & Venue | Comments |
|--------|---------------------------|------------|-----------|--------------------|----------|
| 1      | Assignment 1              | -          | 15 Marks  | --                 |          |
| 2      | Mid Semester Test         | 90 Minutes | 30 Marks  | --                 |          |
| 3      | Assignment 2              | -          | 15 Marks  | --                 |          |
| 4      | Comprehensive Examination | 2/3 Hours  | 40 Marks  | --                 |          |

**7. Chamber Consultation Hour:** To be announced in class.



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**8. Notices:** Notices, if any, concerning the course will be posted on Nalanda.

**9. Attendance Policy:** Each student is expected to attend all classes and participate in all evaluation components.

**10. Criterion for NC:** [30% of the average of the top three performers or 40% of the median, whichever is lower.]

**11. Note (if any):** Students are strongly advised to attend the classes regularly and take the tests on the scheduled dates.

**12. Make Up Policy:** Makeup will be given only for genuine cases (accompanied by proof) for Mid-Sem or comprehensive exam only.

**Instructor-in-charge**  
**Course No. BITS F385**